

Will your app get rejected?

A 30-minute audit for the App Store and Google Play, with a score

THE SHORT ANSWER

Go through the 36 checks below with your app open on a real phone. Every check is worth 1 point. Checks marked **RED FLAG** are the ones reviewers reject for most often, so all of them must pass.

All red flags passed and 32 or more points: submit. Anything less: fix first. A day of fixing beats a week of back-and-forth with review.

Most rejections are self-inflicted. In 2025 Apple reviewed 9.1 million submissions and rejected more than 2 million, and hundreds of thousands of those were approved after the developer fixed the issue. This audit is those fixes, done before you submit.

A. Does it work? (6)

CHECK		✓
Tested on a real iPhone and a real Android phone, including an older one	RED FLAG	☐
No crashes or freezes on any screen	RED FLAG	☐
No placeholder text, "coming soon" screens or dead buttons	RED FLAG	☐
It feels like an app: native screens, and something useful offline	RED FLAG	☐
Every link inside the app opens and works		☐
Works on a slow connection and with no connection (shows a message, doesn't hang)		☐

B. Accounts and privacy (8)

CHECK		✓
If users can sign up, they can delete their account inside the app	RED FLAG	☐
Privacy policy is live, public, and matches what the app collects	RED FLAG	☐
App Privacy (Apple) and Data safety (Google) answers match an SDK audit	RED FLAG	☐
Every permission message says why, in plain words	RED FLAG	☐
AI consent screen before sending data to an AI provider, if you use one	RED FLAG	☐
Tracking permission popup, if you track users for ads across other apps		☐
Google login is offered alongside a private option like Sign in with Apple		☐
Google: a web link for account deletion is in the Data safety form		☐

C. Payments (8)

CHECK		✓
The billed amount is the biggest price on the paywall	RED FLAG	☐
No free trial on/off toggle on the iOS paywall	RED FLAG	☐
Restore purchases button works	RED FLAG	☐
Terms and Privacy links on the paywall	RED FLAG	☐
Subscriptions: Terms of Use (EULA) link in the App Description, or a custom EULA added	RED FLAG	☐
Prices come from the store, never hardcoded		☐
Promoted in-app purchase images are unique, and none is the app icon		☐

CHECK	✓
Buy button text says exactly what happens ("Start my 7-day free trial")	☐

D. Store listing (6)

CHECK	✓
Screenshots show the real app, not mockups of features that don't exist	RED FLAG ☐
No mention of other platforms ("also on Android") in the Apple listing	☐
App name checked in both stores and trademark databases	☐
No other brands in your name, icon or keywords	☐
Age rating and content rating questionnaires answered honestly	☐
App icon looks the same on the phone and in the store	☐

E. Google Play only (5)

CHECK	✓
Targets Android 16 (API level 36), required since August 31, 2026	RED FLAG ☐
New personal account: 12+ testers opted in for 14 days, with real daily use	RED FLAG ☐
Edge-to-edge screens look right: nothing hidden under the status or navigation bar	☐
Special permissions (background location, all-files access, exact alarms) declared, or removed	☐
Pre-launch report checked for crashes	☐

F. Review notes (3)

CHECK ✓		
A working demo email and password (not Google sign-in only)	RED FLAG	☐
Steps to reach the main feature and anything behind the paywall		☐
A short screen recording link for anything a reviewer might miss		☐

Your score

RESULT	WHAT TO DO
All red flags pass, 32 to 36 points	Submit
All red flags pass, 26 to 31 points	Fix the easy ones first. Most take minutes
Any red flag fails	Don't submit. Fix it, whatever the rest of the score is

Let AI run half the audit

Some checks need your eyes on a real phone. Many don't. Run this in Claude Code, Cursor or Antigravity inside your project first:

PROMPT: THE CODE HALF OF THE AUDIT

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Audit this Flutter project before App Store and Google Play submission. Check: account deletion exists if there's sign-up; every permission has a clear purpose string; which SDKs collect data; hardcoded prices; paywall has Restore, Terms and Privacy links and no trial toggle; placeholder text or TODOs in UI; Android targetSdk is 36; dead links. Output a table: check, pass/fail, file and line, and the fix. Don't change any code.
```

📌 MY REAL STORY

- Submitted [DressMirror](#) to App Store, got rejected in 18 hours
- Reason: one of my 5 screenshots had the word Pixar visible on a sample image I generated
- I had not even noticed, it was a watermark leak from a test prompt
- Rejection sat open for 4 days before I spotted the actual reason inside Resolution Center
- Now I audit every screenshot pixel by pixel, run OCR on them, scan for brand names, celebrity faces, copyrighted characters, visible app logos
- 2 minute check saves 4 to 7 days of lost launch momentum, do it before you upload not after

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READ [Apple Newsroom: the App Store in 2025](#)

Apple's own review and rejection numbers.

READ [Google Play: target API level requirements](#)

Official. The API 36 rule.

READ [RevenueCat: R.I.P. toggle paywall](#)

Apple's 2026 paywall rejections, explained.